

3 File management

and settings. The user accounts in Mac OS X have five different level of User Privileges

1.Administrator: You are demi-god once logged on this account and you can do all the maintenance task and make system critical changes. Since this also implies that a mistake can cause total mayhem it is strongly recommended not to use an Administrator Account for day-to-day work.

2.Standard: These accounts are targeted towards everyday use. They give you all the required privileges that you need to make in your everyday working without letting one standard user interfere in the computing experience of any other.

3.Managed with Parental Control: You want your 7-year old boy to have a mail account and play some music but are afraid that he will change some setting or delete one of your files, well look no further.

4.Guest: This account is the answer if you want to lend your computer to someone to do one quick check of his mail but want to be sure that he/she doesn't spook around your stuff or makes any permanent changes to the computer.

5.Sharing Only: This account is for remote connections.

So now let us say you have logged onto a standard account and now when you open the finder window [elaborated below] you will see a set of default folders under a folder with a little hut shaped icon on this. The hut shaped icon folder is your "Home" folder. [this is exactly like the home folder found on Linux machines]

The home folders for each account are located in the Users directory in the file system. Each Home folder further contain folders for pictures, documents, music, desktop, downloads, music etc. Home folder has a permanent place in the sidebar of the finder window from where it can be quickly launched for easy access.

The files and folders that you put on the desktop are also located within you home folder in a folder called "Desktop"

Another folder of note is the "public" folder. This one provides you with an easy interface if you want to share some files over the local network, say a home network. A sub folder is the Drop Box folder which is like a one way shared folder, where users from other computers can drop files for you but they can't remove or modify or copy any files from it. They can't even see its contents. Mac is capable of even hosting a simple website out of the box.

We shall now concentrate on two important aspects, one being the Finder Window and the other being the Dock.